



Several residents, including employees of Chennai's IT and ITes firms, and Global Capability Centres (GCC), had to take refuge in hotels and serviced apartments to continue working

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erations in two to four weeks.

Micro, small and medium enterprises (MSME) in various industrial estates, too, have been severely impacted; they have requested extended deadlines for loan repayments and electricity dues. Per Chennai District MSME Associa-

nai accounts for 10 per cent of all GCCs in India and the state contributes nearly 10 per cent to the \$150-billion-plus Indian IT sector. "Poor city management during the recent rains highlighted business continuity challenges in Chennai. With no power, no internet, and no cellular service,

pled, severely affecting crores of rupees of cargo movements along the east coast corridor. The Southern Railways reported a revenue loss of ₹35 crore in the passenger segment alone as 605 trains were disrupted over four days. The Chennai airport had to shut down its runway and ground all planes from December 4 till 9 am on December 5 after floodwaters entered its premises. Indian airlines cancelled an estimated 600-plus flights over two days.

The office of Tamil Nadu Industries Minister T.R.B. Rajaa did not respond to *BT*'s request for a comment. As Chennai grapples with the aftermath of Cyclone Michaung, questions loom over the city's preparedness to handle risks such as unpredictable weather patterns. Its attractiveness as an ideal investment and business destination, especially with the Global Investors Meet scheduled in Chennai in less than a month, is under scrutiny as well. **BT**

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THE CHENNAI FLOODS DISRUPTED 605 PASSENGER TRAINS, WHILE 600-PLUS FLIGHTS WERE CANCELLED

tion, 30 of the 110 units at Vichoor Industrial Estate were submerged in water after the rains.

Larger MNCs in the IT, ITes, and Global Capability Centre (GCC) sectors fared relatively better, owing to refined business continuity plans after the 2015 floods. But widespread power outages put a dampener on work-from-home (WFH) plans. Residents faced disruptions to telephone and internet connectivity even in areas where power was restored. Chen-

WFH was not possible...this raises the question of Chennai's viability as a ITes/IT GCC [hub]," Gopal Srinivasan, Chairman & MD of private equity fund TVS Capital Funds, posted on social media. Several residents, including IT employees, had to take refuge in hotels and serviced apartments, said hotels, adding that many checked in to continue working.

Operations at key container ports—Chennai Port, Kattupalli Port, and Ennore port—were crip-